

Directions for questions 1 to 5: Identify the incorrect sentence or sentences.

- a. Its easy to get mesmerized by the thick pine forests, green hills, countless waterfalls, and low-hanging clouds in Meghalaya.
- b. But keep an eye out for a Maruti 800 converted into something like an SUV, or a tractor remodeled into a 'jeep'.
- c. The possibilities of spotting something unique whizzing past you on the winding roads of the hill station are very high.
- d. The love for modified cars that people have here stems from pure creativity as more vehicle you spot are not very high-end.
- e. The challenge lies in turning something ordinary into something that is bound to grab eyeballs without spending too much money.

- ☐ a) a and d
- ☐ b) c and e
- ☐ c) a, b and c
- ☐ d) b, d and e
- ☐ a) a and d
- ☐ b) c and e
- ☐ c) a, b and c
- ☐ d) b, d and e

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PREV

Solution:

In a, the apostrophe is missing in the word 'its'. In d, the comparative adjective 'more' is used when there is no comparison. It should be 'most'. Hence b and d are the erroneous sentences while b, c and e are error free sentences. Choice A is the right answer.

Choice (A)

Directions for questions 1 to 5: Identify the incorrect sentence or sentences.

- a. Cynics will say a store needs at least a year or two to see whether they can make the economics work.
- b. The curatorial role once played by a retail outlet have been reduced because you can find anything online and all you need is a smart phone.
- c. But the longevity of a particular store doesn't matter as long as one is replaced by another of equal strength.
- d. For me, a tour of the retail spaces in a city is like being the pilgrim of a smorgasbord of faiths.
- e. The Indian retail space is not a wasteland anymore, thats for sure.

- ☐ a) a and b
- ☐ b) b and e
- ☐ c) a,c and d
- ☐ d) b, d and e

Solution:

In, b the verb 'have' does not agree with the singular subject 'role' In e, the word 'thats' is missing an apostrophe. Hence b and e are sentences with grammatical errors and choice B is the right answer.

Choice (B)

- a. A new study has found that skyscrapers in Singapore adversely affect the life of migratory birds.
- b. The study found that many migratory birds had collided with skyscrapers and died as a result.
- c. It found that some species of birds are most likely to have this kind of an accident than others.
- d. Birds whose migratory routes pass through urban centers are far more prone to either being injured or killed by high-rises.
- e. The problem is made worse by lights in these buildings, which disorient the birds at night and this is a situation not nearly unique to Singapore though, with North America witnessing an estimated 100 million bird deaths due to skyscrapers and high-rises.

- ☐ a) a, d and e
- ☐ b) b and c
- ☐ c) a and c
- ☐ d) c, d and e

Solution:

In a, the word 'life' should be written in the plural because the reference is to the lives of several birds. In c, the comparative adjective 'more' should replace the superlative 'most' in order to denote the comparison evident in the sentence. Statements b, d and e are correct.
Choice (C)

- a. The initiative against the plastic straw had started a little earlier, but it was about two years ago that the campaign took of.
- b. The specific catalyst was a 2015 video that showed a plastic straw jutting out from the nostril of an olive ridley turtle in Costa Rica.
- c. The video that went viral on social media has a marine biologist trying to pull out the straw with pliers, when blood starts to flow from the animal's nose.
- d. The rescuer continues to struggle for nearly five minutes before being able to pull out the nearly-four-inch-long straw, revealing how deep it had been embedded in the animal's body.
- e. The video sparked international outrage, giving wings to a movement to fight the menace of the plastic straw.

- ☐ a) b and c
- ☐ b) b, c and e
- ☐ c) a, b and c
- ☐ d) a and d

Solution:

In a, 'of' is used instead of 'off' — the campaign took *off* is correct. In d, the preposition 'in' is used instead of 'inside' — embedded *inside* the animal's body — is correct. Sentences a and d are erroneous and choice D is the right answer. Choice (D)

Directions for questions 1 to 5: Identify the incorrect sentence or sentences.

- a. A giant tortoise named Abuh, that made a break from a Japanese zoo has been found safe and sound two weeks after it escaped.
- b. Zoo keepers, unable to trace the truant tortoise, offered a reward of 500,000 yen for her safe return.
- c. Their plan proved a success when a sharp-eyed local bounty hunter spotted the roaming reptile in the nearby shrubbery.
- d. The incident was the second time in less than a month that Abuh has disappeared.
- e. Her return home to the zoo was a top item in a TV news bulletin by Japan's public broadcaster NHK.

- ☐ a) a, b and c
- ☐ b) c and d
- ☐ c) c, d and e
- ☐ d) d and e

Solution:

In d, the use of the present perfect tense 'has disappeared' is incorrect. As the reference is to an action completed before a certain time in the past, the past perfect tense 'had disappeared' is appropriate. In e, the use of the preposition 'in' is incorrect. 'On' is the correct preposition to be used here.

Choice (D)

Directions for questions 6 to 10: Each question consists of five sentences on a topic. Some sentences are grammatically incorrect or inappropriate. Select the option that indicates the grammatically correct and appropriate sentence(s).

- a. Originating from his childhood experiences, most of them located in the towering Sivalik mountain range, the overarching theme of the book is the bond of friendship, some lasting for decades and others short-lived, formed by temporary encounters.
- b. Friendship that can exist between children, between the young and the old, between man and beast, between the rich and the poor, among the abled and the disabled.
- c. They talk about the carefree, halcyon days of childhood, about estranged relationships, about hardship, about pain, about loneliness, but above all, they talk about hope, the joys and the ever-lasting impact of friendship.
- d. In *The Crooked Tree*, the author - whilst walking through a field - chances upon Kamal, a young boy who at that moment was having an epileptic fit.
- e. In *A little Friend* he befriends a little mouse that was an illegal tenant in the little attic where he lived.

- ☐ a) c and d
- ☐ b) d and e
- ☐ c) a, b and c
- ☐ d) c, d and e

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PREVIOUS

Solution:

In a, the later part of the sentence talks about the different 'bonds' of friendship. Hence the object should be 'bonds of friendship' and not 'bond of friendship'. In b, when comparing two things which are clearly separated, we use the preposition 'between' and not 'among' and hence it should be between the abled and the disabled. Sentences c, d and e are error free and choice D is the right answer. Choice (D)

Directions for questions 6 to 10: Each question consists of five sentences on a topic. Some sentences are grammatically incorrect or inappropriate. Select the option that indicates the grammatically correct and appropriate sentence(s).

- a. Old spacious buildings have been changed to modern dwelling units that are cramped, have no skylight ventilators and no tiled rooftops.
- b. These tiled rooftops and ventilators were favorite nesting places for the sparrow.
- c. The old grocery stores have been converted to malls or supermarkets, where food is found in packets.
- d. So, sparrows do not find their food grains, which once were available on the road side.
- e. The electromagnetic radiations released from our mobile phones are also a major cause of the decline in the number of sparrows.

- ☐ a) a, b and e
- ☐ b) c, d and e
- ☐ c) b and c
- ☐ d) d and e

Show Correct Answer

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PREVIOUS

Solution:

In c, the preposition 'to' is used instead of 'into'-- converted *into* is correct. In d, the positioning of the adverb 'once' is incorrect. The correction is '----- which were once available'.

Choice (A)

- a. Be like a lotus, let the beauty of your heart speak and be grateful to the mud, water, air and the light.
- b. Whenever you should doubt your self-worth, remember the lotus flower; even though it plunges to life from beneath the mud, it does not allow the dirt that surrounds it to effect its growth or beauty.
- c. The lotus is one strong, powerful, and resilient flower that blossoms in a substance (mud) that none of us would want to touch.
- d. Every struggle is like mud - there are always some lotus seeds waiting to sprout.
- e. Seeing the mud around a lotus is pessimistic, seeing a lotus in the mud is optimism.

- ☐ a) c and e
- ☐ b) a and e
- ☐ c) a, c and d
- ☐ d) b, d and e

Solution:

In b, 'effect' is wrongly used instead of 'affect'. Here, we are talking about the influence of mud on the lotus flower and hence it should be a verb. In e, we have the adjective 'pessimistic' which is incomplete i.e it does not describe or clarify any noun. Hence, the word to be used should be the noun 'pessimism' and the last word 'optimism' gives a clue to this. Hence sentences a, c and d are error free and choice C is the right answer.
Choice (C)

Directions for questions 6 to 10: Each question consists of five sentences on a topic. Some sentences are grammatically incorrect or inappropriate. Select the option that indicates the grammatically correct and appropriate sentence(s).

- a. The lotus flower has a message to convey to humans. Even though the lotus is rooted on mud, it continues to float on the water without becoming wet or muddy.
- b. This aspect of the lotus dictates how humans ought to live in this world - work incessantly and be not attached to the work and to the surroundings.
- c. It also reveals, that this world is not our habitation but one of many stages through which we are passing.
- d. The Bhagavad Gita says, "One who performs his duty without attachment, surrendering the results to the Supreme Lord, is unaffected by sinful action, as the lotus leaf is untouched by water."

- ☐ a) a, d and e
- ☐ b) c, d and e
- ☐ c) a and c
- ☐ d) d and e

Show Correct Answer

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PREVIOUS

Solution:

In b, the preposition 'on' is used instead of 'in' – the lotus is rooted *in* mud is correct. In c, the wrong conjunction 'and' is used instead of 'but'. The contrast indicated in the sentence is best brought out using the conjunction 'but and not and'. Hence a, d and e are error free and choice A is the right answer.
Choice (A)

- a. Its difficult to establish the correlation between education and accomplishment particularly if one examines wealth as the sole variable or the essential parameter.
- b. Of more concern in regard to education is widening the horizon of one's mind.
- c. Where education is viewed in terms of possessing a graduation certificate or a college degree, then there is no relationship between success and education.
- d. For one to be successful in a given profession or field, he and she should have ample knowledge and understanding of the convolutions involved.
- e. Such knowledge does not necessarily come with an academic degree but can be acquired from field experience and the experience of others.

- ☐ a) b and d
- ☐ b) c and e
- ☐ c) b, c and e
- ☐ d) a, d and e

- a. In contemporary Britain, the broadsheet and tabloid press both routinely stereotype opera as 'elitist'.
- b. On the rare occasions when opera singers are interviewed on breakfast television or radio, they are invariably asked to defend their art from the dreaded 'e-word'.
- c. The cliché evokes certain key themes: that opera is posh, expensive and removed from real life.
- d. It is routinely characterised as a pursuit for the privileged: corporate sponsors who listen to horn-helmeted ladies in opulent surroundings but care a little for the music.
- e. The supposed tension between the 'aloofness' of opera and the 'authenticity' of everyday life provides fodder for parody but is a turn-off for potential new audiences.

- ☐ a) c and e
- ☐ b) a, d and e
- ☐ c) c, d and e
- ☐ d) b, d and e

Solution:

In a, "both...and" should be used correctly as a correlative conjunction in order to make the sentence grammatically correct. Hence, "both" should precede "the broadsheet". Therefore, the correction is ;--- both the broadsheet and tabloid press routinely. In b, the preposition "from" should be replaced by "against" because you defend something against something and not from something. In d, the use of the expression "a little" distorts the meaning intended in the sentence. It can be inferred from the sentence that the corporate sponsors did not have any interest in the music. This meaning is conveyed only by the word "little" (meaning practically nil or nothing) and not "a little" (meaning some). Only c and e are free of errors.

Choice (A)

Directions for questions 11 to 15: In each question, there are five sentences or parts of sentences that form a paragraph. Identify the sentence(s) or part(s) of sentence(s) that is/are correct in terms of grammar and usage. Then, choose the **most appropriate** option.

- a. The Folsom spear point, which was excavated in 1927 near the small town of Folsom, New Mexico,
- b. Is one of the most famous artifact in North American archaeology, and for good reason:
- c. It was found in direct association with the bones of an extinct form of Ice Age bison.
- d. The Folsom point, therefore, demonstrated conclusively, and for the first time that human beings were in North America during the last Ice Age -
- e. thousands of years earlier than previously thought.

- ☐ a) a, c and d
- ☐ b) a, c and e
- ☐ c) a, b and d
- ☐ d) a, b, c and d

Solution:

In b, the word "artifact" should be in the plural, in order to agree with the subject "one". The correction is "is one of the most famous artifacts". In d, the expression "and for the first time" is a parenthetical expression which conveys additional information and it should be preceded and followed by commas on its either side. Therefore, a comma should be inserted after the word "time". Parts a, c and e are grammatically consistent.

Choice (B)

Directions for questions 11 to 15: In each question, there are five sentences or parts of sentences that form a paragraph. Identify the sentence(s) or part(s) of sentence(s) that is/are correct in terms of grammar and usage. Then, choose the **most appropriate** option.

- a. The continuing failure of the Myanmar government to act decisively and urgently to protect civilians from the raging crossfire among the security forces and insurgents is shocking.
- b. The recent clashes in the western State of Rakhine have claimed over 70 lives and forced thousands of Rohingyas to flee
- c. over the border into Bangladesh, in a rapidly deteriorating humanitarian crisis.
- d. Most of the victims are women and children, according to the UN's International Organisation for Migration,
- e. which has called for additional aid to cope up with Dhaka's refugee situation.

- ☐ a) b and e
- ☐ b) c, d and e
- ☐ c) b and d
- ☐ d) a, d and e

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PREVIOUS

Solution:

In a, the use of the preposition "among" is incorrect because when we talk about two things "between" is used and if the reference is to more than two things "among" is used. Therefore, in this context "between" is the appropriate preposition. In c, the preposition "over" should be replaced with "across". In part e, the word "cope" should not be followed by "up". The expression "cope up" is grammatically incorrect. Only b and d are free of errors.
Choice (C)

- a. In the nineteenth century, it was supposed that those among the young.
- b. who were destined to take any part in public affairs would obtain what they need from a classical education.
- c. But after the First World War, it became less usual to believe that everybody could be introduced to social obligation solely through the Classics.
- d. Not only some education in Modern History was thought to be useful, but there was much to suggest that the new subject might ultimately take the place of classical studies
- e. by providing, if not the whole, at least the centre and core of the school curriculum on the Arts side.

- ☐ a) b, c and d
- ☐ b) b and d
- ☐ c) a, c and e
- ☐ d) Only d

Solution:

The errors are in parts b and d. In b, the reference is to an action which took place in the distant past, therefore, the verb "need" should be in the past tense. Hence, the correction is "would obtain what they needed". In d, the ordering of the words is incorrect, making the sentence structurally erroneous. The correction is "not only was some education in Modern History thought ----" Parts a, c and e are grammatically correct.

Choice (C)

Directions for questions 11 to 15: In each question, there are five sentences or parts of sentences that form a paragraph. Identify the sentence(s) or part(s) of sentence(s) that is/are correct in terms of grammar and usage. Then, choose the **most appropriate** option.

- a. Natural resources are a critical and often ignored part of our country's national infrastructure.
- b. Boasting 11% of the world's floral and faunal species, India is one of the 17 most ecologically diverse countries.
- c. Blessed with every major ecosystem, these biomes directly contribute billions of dollars to the Indian economy, annually.
- d. The financial value of India's forests, for example which encompass economic services such as timber and fuel wood,
- e. and ecological services such as carbon sequestration, is estimated to be \$1.7 trillions.

- ☐ a) b and c
- ☐ b) b, d and e
- ☐ c) a, c and e
- ☐ d) a and e

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PREVIOUS

Solution:

In a, the use of the conjunction "and" to link the two parts of the sentence is incorrect. 'Yet', meaning nevertheless or despite what has just been said, is the appropriate conjunction to bring out the contrast which is evident in the sentence. In d, "for example" is a parenthetical expression which should be preceded and followed by commas on either side. Hence, a comma should be inserted after "example". In e, the use of the word "trillion" in the plural is incorrect. The correction is "\$ 1.7 trillion". Therefore, a, d and e are incorrect and b and c are grammatically correct. Choice (A)